

Zenovia's Merit-Inclusion Matrix

A 14-Point Strategic Framework to Balance Diversity and Meritocracy

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Theme: Redefining FMCG Leadership through Data-Driven Transparency.

This presentation introduces an original 14-point framework developed specifically to solve the Zenovia Consumer Products Ltd. case study.

The Challenge

- **The Problem:** Zenovia faces an aggressive 12-month deadline to increase female leadership from 9% to 25% for a pre-investor audit.
- **The Conflict:** High-performing employees fear "optics over readiness," while women leaders fear being seen as "symbolic appointments".
- **Our Objective:** To meet diversity targets without eroding trust in the existing merit-based DNA of the 20-year-old organization.



The Merit-Inclusion Model: An Original 14-Point Roadmap

• I. Operational Foundations

1. Equal Training: Standardized skill-building for all.
2. Gender-Neutral Empowerment: Collective growth strategy.
3. Quality Circles: Transparent, collective decision-making.
4. Opportunity Re-activation: Support for high-potential females.

• II. The Merit Engine

5. Qualification Tests: Mandatory exams for high-level roles.
6. Independent Committee: External audit for bias-free results.
7. Cross-Level Engagement: Regular interaction across departments.
8. Interactive Feedback: Direct leadership-employee mentorship.
9. Performance Records: Data-driven grading for promotions.



The Merit-Inclusion Model: An Original 14-Point Roadmap

- **III. Long-Term Trust & Sustainability**

10. Hiring Consensus: Internal review of external hiring.
11. Transparent Onboarding: Communicating merit-first values.
12. Career Pathing: Grooming entry-level talent.
13. Short-Term Targets: Daily HR-managed goals with incentives.
14. Hybrid Point-Grade System: Dual-track eligibility filter.

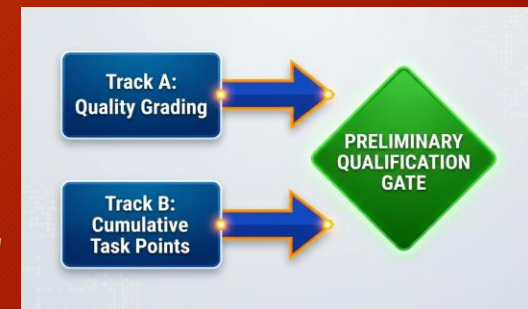
The Core Innovation - Hybrid Evaluation Model (Point 14)

1. Dual-Track Eligibility:

- **Track A (The Performance Track):** Based on high-quality grading from regular work output.
- **Track B (The Effort Track):** Based on cumulative "Task Points" from high-volume work consistency.

2. The Integration: Both tracks lead to the "Preliminary Qualification Gate".

3. Benefit: Provides objective, mathematical proof of "Readiness," eliminating the perception of bias or symbolic hiring.



Balancing Investor Expectations (Solution to Q1)

- **Glass-Box Transparency:** Implementing an **Independent Examination Committee** (Ref: Point 6) ensures bias-free leadership appointments for investor audits.
- **Governance Standard:** Institutionalizing **Qualification Tests** (Ref: Point 5) proves that diversity is a result of a fair filter, not a bypass.
- **Ethical Inclusivity:** Using **Quality Circles** (Ref: Point 3) to set hiring criteria ensures the process is substantive and supported by the 3,500-strong workforce.

Interventions for Trust & Diversity (Solution to Q2)

1. Short-Term Interventions:

- **Micro-Targeting:** Daily Task Points with immediate incentives to boost motivation and unity.
- **Interaction Transparency:** Vertical Feedback Sessions to address employee discomfort immediately.

2. Long-Term Interventions:

- **Structural Grooming:** Targeted orientation for the 38% female workforce at the junior level.
- **Opportunity Re-activation:** Identifying and empowering high-potential women who were previously overlooked.



Risk Mitigation & Conclusion (Solution to Q3)

- **Closing the Credibility Gap:** Ensuring women leaders are seen as credible decision-makers through merit-based pathways.
- **Preventing Talent Attrition:** Maintaining a predictable **Merit-based Hierarchy** to keep high-performers engaged.
- **The Result:** By merging "Capability" and "Diversity" into a single metric, Zenovia achieves substantive inclusion and higher ESG ratings.

Detailed Pdf :

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1pP-rdFb7ILiXxMgO9VyX0XNGnQ8zM6LCTG8Dr5WpGAI/edit?usp=drivesdk>



Thank you